My Just-Right Zone

HOW MY BODY FEELS SAFE

Too High

FIGHT-OR-FLIGHT



I MIGHT FEEL

- mad
- scared
- wiggly
- frustrated
- worried
- bossy
- silly-wild
- jealous

MY BODY MIGHT

- heart goes fast
- fast breathing
- hot face
- tight fists
- tummy ache
- loud voice
- can't sit still
- want to run
- cry or yell

I MIGHT

- hit or throw
- argue
- run away
- not listen

Just Right

MY WINDOW

My body feels calm and safe.

MY BODY FEELS

- steady breathing
- soft muscles
- calm tummy
- ready to learn



WHEN I'M JUST RIGHT I CAN

- play
- listen
- learn
- make friends
- ask for help
- try hard things
- share and take turns
- use my words
- laugh and have fun

Too Low

SHUTDOWN



I MIGHT FEEL

- tired
- sad
- quiet
- far away
- lonely
- bored
- stuck
- empty

MY BODY MIGHT

- feel heavy
- slow and droopy
- yawn a lot
- stare off
- hard to move
- want to hide
- not want to talk

I MIGHT

- hide or cover my face
- stop playing
- not answer
- want to be alone

TOOLS TO GET BACK TO JUST RIGHT

WHEN I'M TOO HIGH

- slow breath out
- squeeze & let go
- cold splash
- hug
- count to 10

WHEN I'M TOO LOW

- jump or stomp
- hum or sing
- stretch
- drink cold water
- name 5 things I see

"Show me where you are. Let's use a tool. I'm back in my just-right zone."

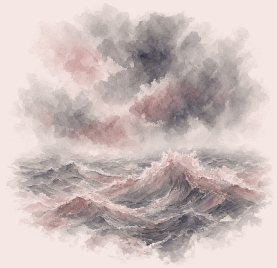
ANCHORED INSIDE | JESSICA PROSSER, LPC

Your Window of Tolerance

UNDERSTANDING YOUR NERVOUS SYSTEM & THE VAGUS NERVE

Hyperarousal

SYMPATHETIC · FIGHT OR FLIGHT



I MIGHT FEEL

- Anxious
- Angry
- Panicky
- Irritable
- Overwhelmed
- Fearful
- Defensive
- Reactive

I MIGHT NOTICE

- Racing heart
- Tense muscles
- Racing thoughts
- Shallow breath
- Hypervigilance
- Sweating
- Jaw clenching
- Restlessness
- Trouble sleeping

I MIGHT

- Snap or argue
- Overthink
- Flee or avoid
- Over-control

Window of Tolerance

VENTRAL VAGAL · SAFE & SOCIAL

Activated enough to engage, calm enough to think.

MY BODY FEELS

- Steady breath
- Relaxed muscles
- Grounded and present



WITHIN MY WINDOW I CAN

- Think clearly
- Stay connected
- Respond, not react
- Problem-solve
- Set boundaries
- Rest and digest
- Tolerate discomfort
- Feel curious and open
- Feel emotions without being overwhelmed

Hypoarousal

DORSAL VAGAL · SHUTDOWN / FREEZE



I MIGHT FEEL

- Numb
- Empty
- Disconnected
- Hopeless
- Exhausted
- Ashamed
- Flat
- Helpless

I MIGHT NOTICE

- Low energy
- Brain fog
- Heavy body
- Slowed thinking
- Low voice
- Spacing out
- Feeling detached
- Wanting to withdraw

I MIGHT

- Withdraw
- Zone out or dissociate
- Struggle to start tasks
- Oversleep

WHAT SHRINKS MY WINDOW

- Chronic stress
- Trauma reminders
- Poor sleep
- Illness or pain
- Overload
- Hunger
- Conflict
- Too much screen time
- Isolation

WHAT EXPANDS MY WINDOW

- Safe relationships
- Co-regulation
- Movement
- Rest
- Long exhale / humming
- Boundaries
- Therapy
- Mindfulness
- Nature
- Play and laughter

Your vagus nerve is always scanning for safety (neuroception). These states aren't choices; they're protection.